October 12, 2026

Dear Dr. Nicolas Lecomte:

Please consider our revised manuscript 'TIM: Tree Imaging Machine for high resolution rapid digital images of tree cores and cookies' as a Practical Tools article for *Methods in Ecology and Evolution*.

We appreciate the additional positive comments and ideas for improvement. Based on the feedback we added a new section in the supplementary material focused on the recreating of TIM. To better illustrate this, a skeleton assembly view of the system, an electrical diagram, and a bill of materials have been added as figures and tables. Furthermore, we provide data of the consistent scanning resolution spanning a large portion of the stitch, using a technique suggested by the editor. Finally, exceedingly large images are now saved to a more common filetype.

We have attempted to address all the editor's concerns and detail our changes in our point-by-point response (note that editor comments are in *italics*, while our responses are in regular text). We feel the new submission is much improved. This Practical Tools article is not under examination for publication elsewhere. We hope that you will find it suitable for *Methods in Ecology and Evolution*, and look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,

The Authors